PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Land Rover Defender (L663)

2020–present · L663 · 90 · 110 · 130

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Recall and campaign status**
  Have a dealer or diagnostic tool confirm every open campaign is closed. Owners on Defender2.net report an airbag recall and the E005 campaign for 3.0 Ingenium diesels built between 1 March 2024 and 18 April 2026, where the auxiliary belt idler pulley can damage the oil pressure and temperature sensor, causing an oil leak and possible stalling.

- [ ] **Oil-change history**
  The headline service interval is long, and some trucks reach their first service on the original oil. Defender2.net members note the oil-change interval is driven by a separate condition-based counter and many owners change oil every 7,000–10,000 miles. A truck with only dealer visits at 21,000-mile intervals deserves a closer look.

- [ ] **DC-DC converter (mild hybrids)**
  MHEV trucks have suffered DC-DC converter failures, with owners reporting waits of two weeks to two months for parts. Ask whether it has been replaced and whether the relevant software updates are done.

- [ ] **Diesel DPF and sensor codes**
  Frequent regenerations (every 35–100 miles) and codes such as P24C6/P24C7 (PM sensor temperature) or P0401 (EGR flow) are documented on the diesels. Scan for stored codes and ask about regeneration frequency before buying a high-mileage D250/D300.

- [ ] **Steering knock on rough roads**
  Several owners report knocking through the steering on corrugations, traced variously to the lower steering-column UJ, track rod ends, front lower control arms or a replacement steering rack under warranty. Wiggle the wheel at a standstill and listen.

- [ ] **Coolant loss (P400)**
  Petrol six-cylinder owners report coolant loss from turbo coolant line O-rings, leaky expansion tanks and stone-damaged auxiliary radiators behind the front intakes. Check the level cold and look for crusty residue.

- [ ] **Coil or air, and which body**
  Land Rover fits air to every 110; a 90 can be either. Coil 90s ride and tow fine but lose the air trucks' height adjustment, sit at about 225 mm instead of up to 291 mm, and are rated to wade 850 mm rather than 900 mm.

YEARS TO KNOW

2020–2024	RECALL	Mild-hybrid trucks covered by DC-DC converter recalls; check the remedy is done

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **DC-DC converter overload can cut drive power (MHEV)**
  2020–2024 · NHTSA 26V248000 / 26V599000
- [ ] **Driver airbag clockspring connector corrosion**
  2020–2026 · NHTSA 26V389000
- [ ] **Engine cam carrier oil channel may be blocked**
  2020–2023 · NHTSA 23V044000
- [ ] **Oil filter housing can crack**
  2023–2024 · NHTSA 24V450000
- [ ] **PCM can switch off while driving (six-cylinder)**
  2020–2021 · NHTSA 21V424000
- [ ] **Smoked rear lights can fail (Defender X)**
  2020–2022 · NHTSA 21V435000
- [ ] **Raised air intake accessory may detach**
  2020–2025 · NHTSA 24E102000
- [ ] **Fuel tank walls too thin**
  2026 · NHTSA 26V263000
- [ ] **Front seat belt pretensioners may be damaged**
  2022–2023 · NHTSA 22V523000
- [ ] **TReK-modified 130: brake calipers may detach**
  2023 · NHTSA 23V789000

- [ ] **Coil or air**
  Land Rover fits air to every 110 and 130. A 90 can be coil or air; coil 90s have about 225 mm clearance, wade 850 mm and have no height modes, while air trucks reach 291 mm at off-road height and wade 900 mm.
- [ ] **Engine**
  US trucks: P300 2.0 four on earlier trucks, P400 3.0 mild-hybrid six, P525 5.0 supercharged V8 and the OCTA's 4.4 twin-turbo V8 (EPA's 2026 list also shows a 130 P300 as a 3.0 six). D-badged diesels and the P400e plug-in weren't sold in the US.
- [ ] **30th Anniversary Edition**
  500 North American 110 P300s in Fuji White on white steel wheels, with the Expedition roof rack and side ladder. Every one wears the same 1/500 badge, so the badge doesn't tell you which number it is.
- [ ] **TReK trucks**
  Ex-competition Defenders from Land Rover's TReK event are sold through the participating retailers with their accessories; Wikipedia puts production at no more than 100 a year, with the number on the badging.
- [ ] **OCTA**
  28 mm taller and 68 mm wider than a standard Defender, with octagon badging; Edition One trucks are Faroe Green.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/land-rover/defender-l663/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks